commercial real-estate sector as well with work from home (WFH) or for that matter ‘work from anywhere’ emerging as the preferred mode of working in the digital environment. The requirement of maintaining larger distance between individuals in offices and additional space needed in homes for conducive working may impact the demand for working space as well.

More on this later.

Trade Added Value at a Fast Clip

Trade, repair, hotels and restaurants are grouped together in one of the four services groups in the National Accounts. Trade accounts for the bulk of value added in this group and has been growing impressively. In current prices, GVA by the trade group in 2018–19 amounted to Rs 20.73 lakh crore, which was 12.1 per cent of the total national GVA of Rs 171.4 lakh crore. GVA in this group is fast catching up in terms of constant prices with the agriculture, forestry and fishing group. GVA of the trade, repair, hotels and restaurants group in 2018–19, at constant prices, was Rs 16.57 lakh crore, almost nine-tenths of the GVA of the agriculture group (Rs 18.72 lakh crore).

The total output value (not GVA) of the trade services group was Rs 30.51 lakh crore at current prices in 2018–19. Of this, trade and repair services contributed Rs 25.46 lakh crore and the hotel and restaurants group contributed Rs 5.04 lakh crore of output value. In terms of GVA, the contribution of the trade and repairs group was Rs 19 lakh crore while that of hotels and restaurants only Rs 1.72 lakh crore. More than 91.6 per cent of the value added was from the trade and repairs segment.

Indeed, the growth of the trade and repairs group, in constant prices, has been impressive during the second decade of the twenty-first century. GVA in constant prices for the group in 2010–11 was Rs 8.83 lakh crore, which